The Next Page

A vision born from experience

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Building whole communities, one life at a time...



FROM THE EDITORS

Our first chapter

Every organisation has a first page. This is ours.

Welcome to the first edition of The Next Page, the newsletter of The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF), a Uganda-based nonprofit working towards stronger, more resilient communities through education, health, livelihoods and care for the environment.

We are at the beginning, and we would rather say so plainly. Our legal registration is in its final stages, our policies and systems are being built, and our programmes are still in design. We are not yet accepting funds.

What we can offer today is an honest account of where we stand, the story of why we exist, and a plan we are ready to share: Read to Lead, a community centre with a library at its heart, proposed for Pakele and Teopok on land we have already acquired.

We will report honestly in every edition, including on what has not yet happened. We hope you will walk with us, and watch each next page being written.

The Editors

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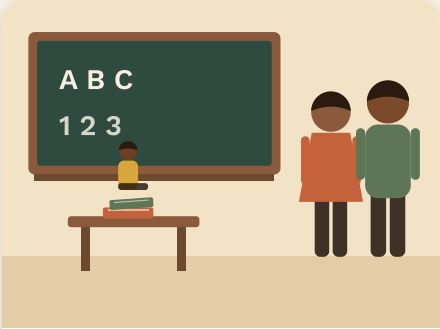
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TJF-The Next Page is the newsletter of The Jopetnah Foundation.

THE FOUNDER'S STORY

The lesson that came home

Two teachers raised him to believe in learning. A sudden financial shock showed him how fragile family stability can be.



An inheritance
Both his parents were teachers. Learning was the climate of home.



An interruption
A breach of trust at work shook the family's income and cash flow.



A purpose
The question grew into a conviction: no child's future should depend on one family's bad year.

Illustrations are symbolic. They are not portraits of the Founder's family.

Before he was a finance professional, before he was a founder, Mr Okello Carlos Torach was the child of two teachers.

In that kind of home, education is not an event. It is the climate: the quiet expectation that a question deserves an answer, and the belief that knowledge opens doors that circumstances can close. His parents' profession was helping other people's children learn. They gave him an inheritance that cannot be banked: respect for the classroom and for the people who stand in it.

Years later, he built a career in finance and administration, including as Acting National Coordinator of a non-profit organisation. Then, at one point in his professional life, a manager committed a serious breach of trust that severely disrupted his income and the family's cash flow. The effects reached far beyond money. Family stability was shaken, and he saw how quickly a household's footing can go.

That is not a statistic. It is a question that cannot be set aside: how quickly can a child's future be put on pause by something no child chose? The answer was uncomfortable. Very quickly.

> **A child's education can be interrupted by circumstances the child neither created nor controls.**

The question did not go away. If a household that valued learning this much could be shaken so quickly, how many other children face the same kind of interruption with no one able to find a way through? That question became a conviction, and the conviction became The Jopetnah Foundation.

TJF is not built on the idea that one person can fix every hardship. It is built on a smaller, harder idea: that a personal experience of vulnerability can be turned into organised, collaborative, long-term action, with communities as partners and with careful stewardship of every resource entrusted to it.



"I founded The Jopetnah Foundation because I learned how quickly financial hardship can disrupt lives, and how much difference practical support and opportunity can make. That experience deepened my understanding of the struggles other families face and strengthened my resolve to help build communities where people have greater opportunities to overcome hardship and realise their potential."

Mr Okello Carlos Torach, Founder and Executive Director



A MESSAGE FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Where a child begins should not set the limit of what that child can become

Mr Okello Carlos Torach · Founder and Executive Director

Dear friends,

Welcome to the first edition of The Next Page, and thank you for opening it.

I began The Jopetnah Foundation because of something I learned the hard way: how quickly a family's stability, and with it a child's schooling, can be shaken. I learned a second lesson from the other side of my upbringing. My parents were teachers, and I grew up believing that learning is one of the most reliable ways a person can move towards a better life. When those two truths met in my own life, I could no longer treat them as separate subjects.

That is why TJF cares about more than classrooms. We exist to support children, families and underserved communities through practical, sustainable and collaborative approaches, beginning in Uganda. We care about education and literacy, and just as much about health, livelihoods and the environment, because a child learns best when a family is steady and a community is strong.

> I will not promise what we have not yet earned.

Our first initiative to share is Read to Lead: a proposed community centre with a library at its heart, planned for Pakele and Teopok on land we have already acquired. It is a plan, not yet a building. It will need partners, resources, trust and patience, and it will need the communities it is meant for to shape it.

What I can promise is this. We will listen before we act. We will report honestly on what we do, including when progress is slow. And we will treat every contribution of money, books, time or expertise with care.

If this edition moves you, please walk alongside us: read, share, write to us, and offer what you can. Where a child begins should not set the limit of what that child can become.

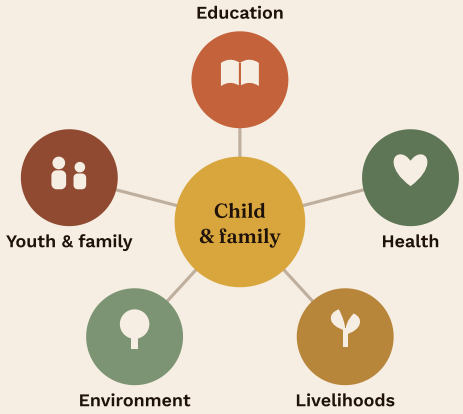
With commitment and hope,

Okello Carlos Torach

Mr Okello Carlos Torach
Founder and Executive Director
The Jopetnah Foundation

OUR APPROACH

Whole communities, one life at a time



A child's schooling depends on more than a classroom. It depends on a family's stability, on health, on a household's livelihood, on a supportive community, and on an environment that can sustain it. So we design across five connected priorities:

- **Education and literacy:** access to learning and to books
- **Health and wellbeing:** prevention, health education and referral
- **Livelihoods:** skills and economic opportunity
- **Environment:** resilience where families live
- **Child, youth and family development:** strengthening the household around the learner

These are our aspirations and design direction. We will report what we do, and what we learn, once there are activities to report.

FEATURE

Read to Lead: a library with a community around it

A proposed community centre for Pakele in Adjumani District and Teopok in Omoro District

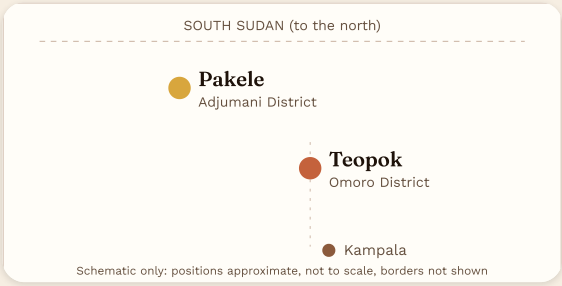
Picture the smallest unit of hope in a community: a child who has a book to take home.

Read to Lead is TJF's proposed educational initiative, and its heart is a community centre with a library at its centre, planned for Pakele in Adjumani District and Teopok in Omoro District, Northern Uganda. Our aim is to serve about 1,000 children and adults across the two centres, roughly 500 at each. The two sites were chosen because of land availability, real need and local interest.

We do not think of a library as a room of books. We think of it as a place where curiosity is nurtured, where children discover what is possible, where young people gain confidence, and where adults can keep learning. The centre we are planning would bring together:

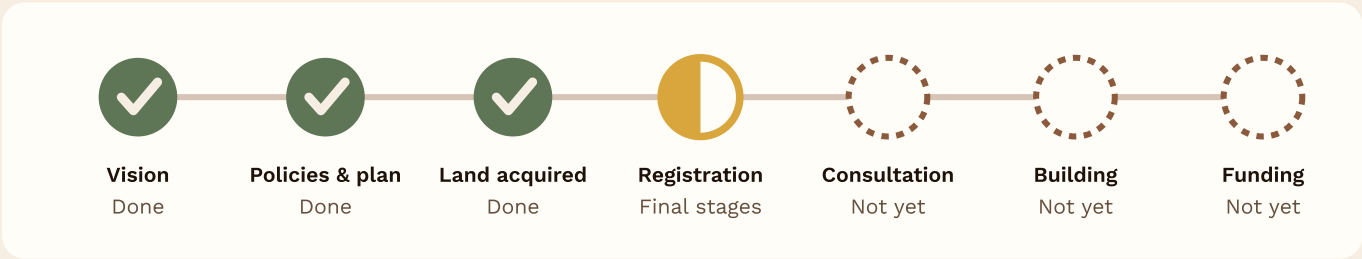
- a community library and reading resources
- literacy and reading activities for children
- mentoring and positive role models for young people
- practical digital skills, as resources allow
- family and community gatherings
- learning and personal-development opportunities for adults

These pieces strengthen one another. A child who reads with a mentor builds confidence. A parent who learns a new skill brings new possibilities home. A community that gathers around a shared place begins to own it.



> **A library is a promise that tomorrow's questions will have somewhere to go.**

Where we are, plainly



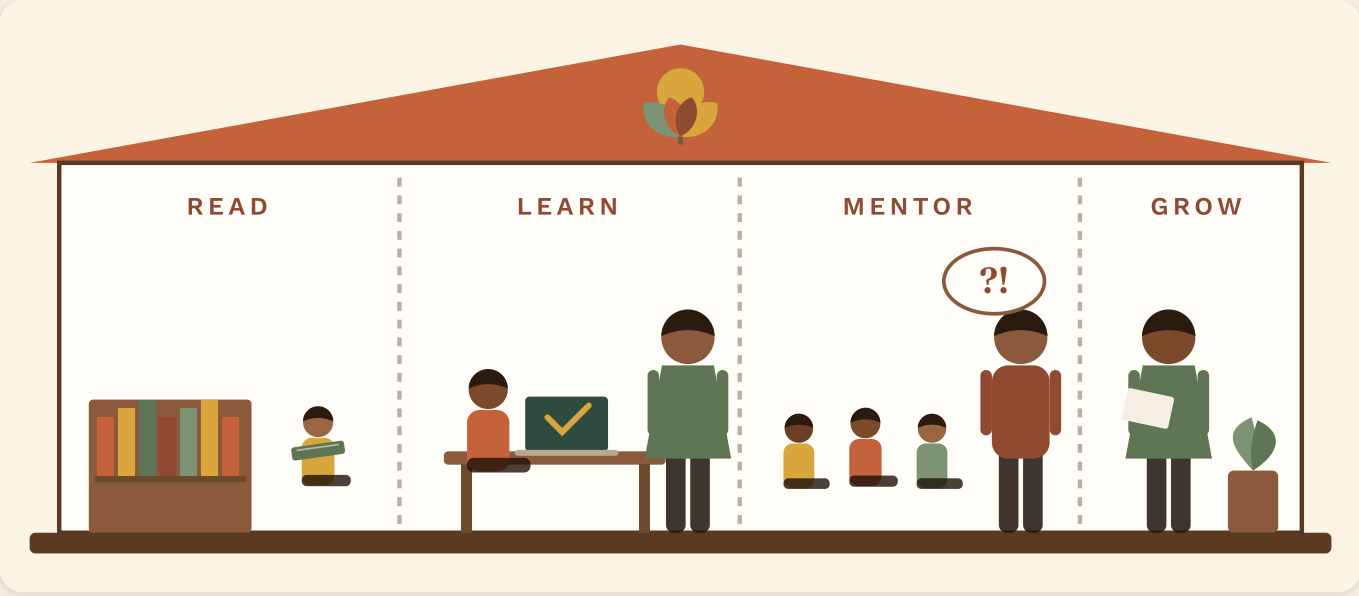
Read to Lead is a plan in development. Land has been acquired in both locations, but nothing has been built, approvals and designs are still to come, and no funding has been committed. We are completing our registration, writing our policies and systems, and preparing to consult each community, in local languages, before any design is fixed. Funding will be sought only when our legal, governance and financial systems are ready.

Next milestone: community consultation, in local languages, once registration is complete. **What follows:** district engagement, a baseline survey, partnership building, and the resources, books and technical support the centre will need.

AN IMAGINED ILLUSTRATION

A day at the centre

This is what the centre could one day offer. It is not a report of events that have happened.



It is mid-afternoon. A girl of nine sits cross-legged by a low shelf, turning the pages of a picture book she will be allowed to borrow. Across the room, a young man finishes his first lesson on a computer and says, to nobody in particular, “I did it.” A volunteer mentor sits with a group of teenagers, asking what they would like to be and listening to the answers. In the hall, a mother is reading a leaflet about a skills class for adults, and wondering whether she might join.

> No one in the room is a case study. Each is a person with a next page.

PARTNER WITH PURPOSE

Help open the doors to possibility

You do not need to start with money. We welcome:

Funding and grants

When our systems are ready. Online donations are not active yet.

Books and materials

Books, educational materials and library resources, under our donation guidelines.

Digital equipment

Computers and digital-learning equipment as the project develops.

Volunteers and mentors

Literacy and mentoring volunteers, who complete our safeguarding process first.

Expertise

Librarianship, architecture, monitoring and evaluation, safeguarding, fundraising advice.

Partnerships

Institutional, educational and corporate partners, agreed in writing.

All support is accepted in line with our safeguarding requirements and financial controls. Please contact us before sending anything.

How you can help turn this page

Choose the path that fits you. Each starts with a conversation.

If you are a donor or institutional funder

Open the doors with us. TJF is preparing Read to Lead and building the legal, governance and financial systems that responsible funding requires. If your institution funds education, literacy or community development, we would welcome a conversation now about what you would need to see, so we can be ready when we open to funding. We will send our concept note, policies and plan.

If you are a volunteer, educator or mentor

Lend us your skills, not just your good wishes. We are looking for librarians, teachers, mentors, literacy specialists and digital-skills trainers to advise on Read to Lead and, as it develops, to take part. All volunteers complete our safeguarding process before any contact with children.

If you are a corporate, academic or implementation partner

Build the next page with us. We welcome companies, universities, schools, libraries and implementing organisations that can contribute books, equipment, expertise, research support or local partnership. Partnerships will be agreed in writing, in line with our safeguarding and financial-control policies.

WRITE TO US

thejopetnahfoundation@gmail.com

Project page: the-jopetnah-foundation-tjf.github.io/the-jopetnah-foundation/community-centre.html
Volunteer, in-kind and partner enquiries: use the contact form on the website and choose your option.
Telephone: +256 782 520 058

This is a beginning, and we want to say so. We do not claim to have every answer, and we know the work ahead is larger than any one organisation. Thank you for reading the first page. We hope you will stay for the next.

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